APPROVED ON NOVEMBER 4, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

County Administration Workshop: October 27, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. **Department Business**

   a. District Attorney

      1. **Amendment No. 1 to Oregon DOJ Grant Award VOCA/CFA-2025-JosephineCo.DAVAP-00002 – Adds Year 2 funding; total award VOCA $325,156.00 and CFA $122,205.41 – Approval and signature**

Maria Huling, Chief Administrative Assistant, District Attorney's Office, presented Amendment No. 1 to the Oregon Department of Justice Crime Victim and Survivor Services Division 2025-2026 VOCA/CFA Non-Competitive Grant Award (VOCA/CFA-2025-JosephineCo.DAVAP-00002), adding the second year of funding for October 1, 2026 through September 30, 2027. The grant supports the Victim Assistance program, including the program manager, two full-time advocates, and one part-time advocate who assist victims with court appearances, victims' rights, notifications, and other case-related needs. With the amendment, the total award is $325,156.00 in VOCA funds and $122,205.41 in CFA funds.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Amendment No. 1 to Grant Award VOCA/CFA-2025-JosephineCo.DAVAP-00002 and authorize the Board to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

   b. Finance

      1. **National Association of Counties (NACo) 2027 County Membership Dues – Invoice No. 202653960 – $1,762.00 – Approval to pay**

Matt Eide, Finance Director, presented the 2027 National Association of Counties (NACo) membership invoice in the amount of $1,762.00. Mr. Eide reported that he had not identified recent County projects, event participation, or steering-committee involvement attributable to the membership. The Board discussed the weekly information and data provided by NACo, including information that had been forwarded to Veterans Services and occasional grant opportunities, and agreed that the County should make greater use of the organization. The Board supported paying the dues for one additional year and evaluating the membership's value and County participation during that period.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve payment of the 2027 National Association of Counties membership dues in the amount of $1,762.00. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Forestry

1. **Tree Planting Contract 2026PL-3 with Rogue River Forestry LLC – Approximately 173,500 seedlings on 422 acres at $460–$520 per thousand (estimated $79,488) – Approve contract and authorize Dave Streeter to sign**

Dave Streeter, Forestry Director, presented Tree Planting Contract 2026PL-3 with Rogue River Forestry LLC for planting approximately 173,500 conifer seedlings on 422 acres in nine units of County forest lands during the fall 2026 and winter 2027 planting seasons, at bid prices of $460 to $520 per thousand seedlings, an estimated $79,488. Mr. Streeter explained that reforestation is a routine part of County forest management and that trees are planted at a higher density than the eventual stand because not all seedlings survive. Forestry staff conduct quality-control checks while planting is underway and later perform stocking surveys to evaluate survival and contractor performance.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Tree Planting Contract 2026PL-3 with Rogue River Forestry LLC and authorize Dave Streeter to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Sheriff

1. **Purchase of five (5) 2026 Chevrolet Tahoe patrol vehicles for new deputy positions – OregonBuys Contract PO-107-00012917 – $287,649.40 plus $130,000 upfitting, from the Sheriff's Equipment Reserve Fund – Approval**

Sheriff Dave Daniel presented the request to purchase five 2026 Chevrolet Tahoe patrol vehicles for the patrol deputy positions added in the 2026-27 budget, through OregonBuys Contract PO-107-00012917, at $57,529.88 each for a total of $287,649.40, plus approximately $130,000 for upfitting, funded from the Sheriff's Equipment Reserve Fund. Sheriff Daniel stated that the Tahoes were selected for their four-wheel-drive capability, size, durability, and officer-safety advantages, and that he intends to transition the patrol fleet back toward Tahoes as vehicles become available. Because the Sheriff's Office has added positions, the five vehicles are additions to the fleet rather than immediate replacements; future vehicle purchases are expected to begin replacing older units.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the purchase of five 2026 Chevrolet Tahoe patrol vehicles under OregonBuys Contract PO-107-00012917 for $287,649.40, plus $130,000 for upfitting, from the Sheriff's Equipment Reserve Fund. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. **Fund 26 Animal Control Budget – Reduce contingency by $27,400 to increase personnel ($10,100, 10% COLA) and vehicle expense ($17,300) – Approval**

Sheriff Dave Daniel presented the request to reduce Fund 26 contingency by $27,400 to increase the Animal Control Division personnel budget by $10,100, to $398,900, and the vehicle expense budget by $17,300, to $72,400. The personnel adjustment reflects the Sheriff's Association collective bargaining agreement, which was finalized after the budget was prepared. The vehicle adjustment reflects both higher fuel prices than budgeted and increased mileage, with the three Animal Control vehicles averaging approximately 6,100 miles per month compared with the approximately 4,500 miles per month originally budgeted. Sheriff Daniel also reported that Animal Control calls for service have continued to increase. The requested adjustments are funded from the existing Fund 26 contingency.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve reducing Fund 26 contingency by $27,400 to increase the Animal Control Division personnel budget by $10,100 and vehicle expense budget by $17,300. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. **Portable Radio Purchase – Portable radios for the new patrol deputy positions added in the 2026-27 budget; the budgeted APX6000 model versus a newer model compatible with an upgraded radio system at a higher cost – Discussion**

Sheriff Dave Daniel discussed portable radios for the new patrol deputy positions. The budget assumed purchase of APX6000 radios; however, information received from Day Wireless indicated that the budgeted model may not be compatible with a future modernized County radio infrastructure. Sheriff Daniel advised that the five mobile, in-car radios previously authorized remain current and will proceed for installation in the new patrol vehicles. The Board agreed to defer a decision on portable radios until pricing and additional information are available regarding interoperability, useful life, and the County's broader communications-system plan. The item will return to a future Administrative Workshop.

No formal action was taken.

e. Human Resources

1. **Position Requisition**

   a. Public Health – WIC Certifier – Refill Vacating Position – Vacating 10/26/2026

   b. Public Works – Department Specialist – Replace Existing Classification

   c. Public Works – Public Works Manager – EOF – Replace Existing Classification

   d. Sheriff – Deputy Corrections – Refill Vacated Position – Vacated 10/02/2026

   e. Sheriff – Sergeant – Refill Vacated Position – Vacating 1/07/2027

2. **Personnel Actions**

   a. Community Corrections – Parole and Probation Officer – Re-hire

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the position requisitions and personnel action. Public Health requested refilling a vacant WIC Certifier position. Public Works requested replacing an existing Department Specialist classification with a senior-level Department Specialist and replacing a Public Works Manager position with an engineering position already within the department's structure. The Sheriff's Office requested refilling a vacant Corrections Deputy position and beginning recruitment for a Sergeant position expected to become vacant January 7, 2027, noting that Sergeant recruitment may require both internal and external processes. Community Corrections requested rehiring a former Parole and Probation Officer at the level held when the employee left earlier in the year; the employee's certifications remain current. The Board had no further questions, and the requisitions and personnel action were left for signature.

3. **Executive Session**

a. Real Properties in Relation to the Sale of the Flying Lark – ORS 192.660(2)(e)

Chair Ron Smith called for Executive Session at 1:57 p.m. under ORS 192.660(2)(e), to conduct deliberations with persons designated by the governing body to negotiate real property transactions. Minutes filed separately.

Additional Attendees: Wally Hicks, Legal Counsel; Helene Lulich, Property Manager; Tamra Martin, Recreation Director, Chris Bristol, Daily Courier

Executive Session adjourned at 2:35 p.m.

4. **Open Session of the Admin Workshop**

a. Real Properties in Relation to the Sale of the Flying Lark

The Board reconvened in Open Session at 2:35 p.m. and directed staff to continue negotiations regarding the real property interests associated with the Flying Lark transaction. Chair Smith then called a brief recess. The Administrative Workshop reconvened at 2:39 p.m.

5. **Board Business**

a. Resolution No. 2026-040 – Re-Appointments to the Josephine Housing and Community Development Council – Jean Ann Miles, City of Cave Junction representative (term expiring May 4, 2031), and Mark Jones, Public At Large (term expiring June 1, 2031)

The Board considered Resolution No. 2026-040, re-appointing Jean Ann Miles as the City of Cave Junction representative for a five-year term expiring May 4, 2031, and Mark Jones as a Public At Large member for a five-year term expiring June 1, 2031, on the Josephine Housing and Community Development Council. The Board noted the continued participation of the appointees and proceeded to the resolution.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve Resolution No. 2026-040, In the Matter of a Re-Appointment to the Josephine Housing and Community Development Council. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson – Yes; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Critical Oregon Airport Relief (COAR) Grant Program – Oregon Department of Aviation (ODAV) – Discussion

Commissioner Martin and Mike Crisafulli, Airports Manager, discussed the Critical Oregon Airport Relief (COAR) grant program administered by the Oregon Department of Aviation. The program includes funding priorities for FAA grant match, Cascadia/emergency preparedness, and economic development. The proposed Illinois Valley Airport application would seek approximately $150,000 for economic-development infrastructure and would initially focus on developing four of the airport's sixteen industrial lots, including water and wastewater needs. Existing wells are low-producing and require evaluation, and above-ground water storage was discussed as a possible alternative for fire-suppression needs. The grant application was due Friday. A grant of $150,000 would require an approximately ten-percent local match, bringing the potential project commitment to approximately $166,667; any final local-match commitment or grant acceptance would return to the Board as necessary.

Without objection, the Board authorized staff to proceed with the COAR grant application.

c. Department Reviews – Board of Commissioners Office Department Report, FY 2025-26 – Commissioner Richardson (continued from October 20, 2026)

Commissioner Richardson reviewed the draft Department Report form using the Board of Commissioners Office as the initial test department before the form is distributed Countywide. The Board discussed the purpose of the report as a recurring tool for departmental updates, performance and accountability measures, public information, and preparation for future budget discussions. Commissioner Richardson noted that an overtime measure had been added and that testing the form had identified a need for clearer instructions to reduce confusion and ensure consistent responses. The Board agreed to continue refining the form and to use the Board Office report as the first presentation before rolling the process out to other departments.

The Board Office Department Report will return the following week for presentation and further refinement. No formal action was taken.

d. Commissioner Proposal: The 90-Day Airport Lease Modernization Program – Request that the Board direct the Department of Airports to implement the program on the proposed

schedule, adopt the milestones as Board deadlines, and require written progress reports – Commissioner Richardson

Commissioner Richardson presented a proposed 90-Day Airport Lease Modernization Program intended to accelerate the review and updating of airport leases. Commissioner Richardson and Mike Crisafulli, Airports Manager, discussed the different lease types, revised templates, historical lease terms that require individual review, and the number of leases still needing work. Mr. Crisafulli advised that approximately 82 leases require some level of review or correction and that the work must account for prior agreements, leasehold rights, rate consistency, insurance requirements, and other property-specific history rather than simply replacing every lease with the same form. The Board also discussed use of the Re-Leased property-management software, which is currently being used primarily as a document repository but has additional capabilities for lease tracking, notices, payments, and reporting. The Board emphasized the need to move the lease work forward while maintaining consistent and defensible terms for airport tenants.

No formal action was taken.

Commissioner Richardson and Mike Crisafulli will return to the Administrative Workshop in two weeks with an adjusted implementation plan, including proposed goals and timelines for lease cleanup and use of the Re-Leased system.

6. **OTHER**

None heard.

7. **ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

Chair Smith announced that on Friday, October 30, the Oregon Geologic Service would give a public presentation at the auditorium regarding survey work conducted in Josephine County on historic mine tailings and potential strategic metals.

Chair Smith adjourned the meeting at 3:17 p.m.